

Jakob Kasper

Ph.D. Researcher in Political Psychology

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Education

Ph.D. Communication Science, University of Amsterdam, The Netherlands 2023-2026 (Submission in October)
Supervisors: Dr. Bert N. Bakker (Communication Science) & Prof. Gijs Schumacher (Political Science)
Project: MSCA Doctoral Network "Interdisciplinary Perspectives on the Politics of Adolescence and Democracy"

M.Sc. Psychology, University of Heidelberg, Germany 2020–2023
Supervisors: Prof. Tom Gilovich (Cornell University) & Prof. Klaus Fiedler
Thesis: *Do People Prefer to Share Political Information that Boosts their Ingroup or Derogates the Outgroup?*

Graduate Exchange Student, Cornell University, USA 2021–2022
Supervisors: Prof. David Pizarro & Prof. Tom Gilovich

B.Sc. Psychology, University of Heidelberg, Germany 2017–2020
Supervisors: Prof. Klaus Fiedler & Prof. Florian Kutzner
Thesis: *On the Role of Exploitation and Exploration Strategies in the Maintenance of Cognitive Biases*

Grants, Awards & Honors

Cornell Center for Social Sciences Research Grant (\$6,505.00, Role: Co-PI) 2025
Polarization Research Lab Time-Sharing Survey Module (competitive application, $N = 1,000$) 2024
Baden-Württemberg Foundation Travel Scholarship 2021
University of Heidelberg Undergraduate Psychology Conference Poster Prize, 2. Rank 2021

Peer-Reviewed Publications

Kasper, J., Schumacher, G., & Bakker, B. N. (2025). *Establishing the Construct and Predictive Validity of Brief Measures of Affective Polarization*. *European Journal of Political Research*. doi: 10.1111/1475-6765.70022

Laffineur, C., Kasper, J., te Brinke, L., Bakker, B. N., & Schumacher, G. (2025). *Political Interest, Activism, and Affective Polarization: Dutch Adolescents and Adults are not that Different*. *Tijdschrift voor Communicatiewetenschap*. doi: 10.5117/TCW2025.2.006.LAFF

Kasper, J., & Gilovich, T. (2025). *Do people prefer to share political information that boosts their ingroup or derogates the outgroup?* *Journal of Experimental Psychology: General*. doi: 10.1037/xge0001683

Kasper, J., & Bakker, B. N. (2025). *Alexa Bankert. When Politics Becomes Personal: The Effect of Partisan Identity on Anti-Democratic Behavior*. *Public Opinion Quarterly*. doi: 10.1093/poq/nfaf025

Kasper, J., Fiedler, K., Kutzner, F., & Harris, C. (2023). *On the role of exploitation and exploration strategies in the maintenance of cognitive biases: Beyond the pursuit of instrumental rewards*. *Memory & Cognition*. doi: 10.3758/s13421-023-01393-8

Manuscripts Under Review

Kasper, J., Bakker, B. N., Lelkes, Y., & Schumacher, G. (under review). *Beyond Valence: Arousal as a Core Dimension of Affective Polarization*. doi: 10.31234/osf.io/5dfbj_v1

Schumacher, G., Kasper, J., Van der Velden, M.A.C.G., Zaslove, M., Rooduijn, M. & Bakker, B. N. (under review). *Strengthening Democracy with Interventions: A Conceptual Replication of a Megastudy in the Netherlands*. doi: 10.31234/osf.io/g2zfc_v1

Kasper, J., Schumacher, G., te Brinke, L., Crone, E., & Bakker, B. N. (under review). *Coming of Age in Polarized Times: Affective Polarization Across Adolescence*.

van de Wetering, J., Bakker, B. N., van den Bos, W., te Brinke, L., Green, K., van de Groep, S., Kasper, J., Ma, I., Schumacher, G., Sweijen, S., & Crone, E. (in prep). *Youth Perspectives on Polarization: Concerns and Intervention Pathways*.

Manuscripts In Preparation

Kasper, J., Lee, R. T., Pennycook, G., Binnendyk, J., & Sezer, O. (under review). *People overestimate support for “cancellation”*.

Tsakiris, M., Arahall, I., Kasper, J., Kegel, J., Nika, C., & Niraki, M. (in prep). *Coming of Age at the Ballot: Public and Expert Attitudes towards the Ideal Voting Age*.

Conference Presentations & Workshops

Schumacher, G., Kasper, J., Van der Velden, M.A.C.G., Zaslove, M., Rooduijn, M. & Bakker, B. N. (2026, September). *Strengthening Democracy with Interventions: A Conceptual Replication of a Megastudy in the Netherlands*. Talk presented at the biannual meeting of the German Society for Psychology.

- Kasper, J., Schumacher, G., te Brinke, L., Crone, E., & Bakker, B. N.** (2026, July). *The Development, Level, and Malleability of Affective Polarization among Adolescents*. Talk presented at the annual meeting of the International Society for Political Psychology.
- Kasper, J., Schumacher, G., te Brinke, L., Crone, E., & Bakker, B. N.** (2026, June). *The Development, Level, and Malleability of Affective Polarization among Adolescents*. Talk presented at the meeting of the European Association for Social Psychology
- Kasper, J., Schumacher, G., te Brinke, L., Crone, E., & Bakker, B. N.** (2026, May). *The Development, Level, and Malleability of Affective Polarization among Adolescents*. Talk presented at the IP-PAD Conference “Becoming Political: Adolescence and the Future of Democracy”
- Kasper, J., Schumacher, G., te Brinke, L., Crone, E., & Bakker, B. N.** (2026, February). *The Development, Level, and Malleability of Affective Polarization among Adolescents*. Talk presented at the 24h Communication Science Conference 2026.
- Kasper, J., Schumacher, G., te Brinke, L., Crone, E., & Bakker, B. N.** (2026, February). *The Development, Level, and Malleability of Affective Polarization among Adolescents*. Talk presented at the German Political Psychology Meeting 2024.
- Kasper, J., Bakker, B. N., Lelkes, Y., & Schumacher, G.** (2025, November). *Beyond Valence: Arousal as a Core Dimension of Affective Polarization*. Talk presented at the Polarization Consortium Workshop.
- Kasper, J., Schumacher, G., te Brinke, L., Crone, E., & Bakker, B. N.** (2025, November). *The Development, Level, and Malleability of Affective Polarization among Adolescents*. Poster presented at the IP-PAD Doctoral Network Conference.
- Kasper, J., Bakker, B. N., Lelkes, Y., & Schumacher, G.** (2025, July). *Beyond Valence: Arousal as a Core Dimension of Affective Polarization*. Talk presented at the Political Identities Workshop of the Amsterdam Centre for European Studies.
- Kasper, J., Bakker, B. N., Lelkes, Y., & Schumacher, G.** (2025, July). *Conceptualizing and Measuring Affective Polarization: The Role of Valence and Arousal*. Talk presented at the annual meeting of the International Society for Political Psychology.
- Kasper, J., Schumacher, G., & Bakker, B. N.** (2025, July). *Conceptualizing and Measuring Affective Polarization: The Role of Valence and Arousal*. Talk presented at the Dutch Political Science Conference 2025.
- Kasper, J., Schumacher, G., & Bakker, B. N.** (2024, September). *Putting the Affect into Affective Polarization: New Insights into Conceptualization and Measurement*. Talk presented at the German Political Psychology Meeting 2024.
- Kasper, J., Schumacher, G., & Bakker, B. N.** (2024, February). *Establishing the Construct and Predictive Validity of Brief Measures of Affective Polarization*. Talk presented at the 24h Communication Science Conference 2024.
- Kasper, J., & Gilovich, T.** (2022, May). *Do People Prefer to Share Political Information that Boosts their Ingroup or Derogates the Outgroup?* Talk presented at the 2022 Six College (Columbia, Cornell, CUNY, NYU, Princeton, Yale) Conference.
- Kasper, J., Kaulhausen, F., Lob, A., & Scholten, F.** (2018, October). *Too far to change? How psychological distance shapes our pro-environmental behavior*. Poster presentation at the Undergraduate Psychology Research Conference at the University of Heidelberg.

Popular Press & Dissemination

- van de Wetering, J., Bakker, B. N., van den Bos, W., te Brinke, L., Green, K., van de Groep, S., **Kasper, J.**, Ma, I., Nabben, F., Schumacher, G., Sweijen, S., Toenders, Y., & Crone, E. (2026, March). *Jongerenperspectief op polarisatie. Van verdeeldheid naar verbinding*. <https://heyzine.com/flip-book>
- Kasper, J.** (2026, January). *Politics Doesn't Define How Most People See Themselves. The Inquisitive Mind*. <https://www.in-mind.org/blog>
- Bakker, B. N., & **Kasper, J.** (2026, January). *Stop Formatting Before the Desk Reject: A Proposal for Staged Submissions. Blog of Trial and Error*. <https://doi.org/10.36850/0fe2a79d-7165>
- Bakker, B. N., **Kasper, J.**, & Schumacher, G. (2025, July). *Vanaf 16 stemmen? Jongere is er klaar voor. Algemeen Dagblad*. <https://www.ad.nl/opinie>
- Kasper, J.**, & Gilovich, T. (2025, June). *Why Do Hostile Posts Go Viral When Most People Prefer More Positive Communication? SPSP Character & Context Blog*. <https://spsp.org/>
- Schumacher, G., & Bakker, B. N., **Kasper, J.**, & Zaslove, M. (2024, December). *Alarmisme over antidemocratische jongeren is misplaatst. StukRoodVlees*. <https://stukroodvlees.nl/alarmisme-over-antidemocratische-jongeren-is-misplaatst/>
- SYNC Lab & **HotPoliticsLab** (2023, December). *Fact Sheet: Hoe denken jongeren over politiek?* link to fact sheet

Teaching Experience

- Lecturer, Research Seminar (BA, 25 students) - Experiments, University of Amsterdam** 2026
Teaching a hybrid tutorial course on experimental research methods and statistics, including the supervision of student projects and grading of individual essays and exams.
- Co-Lecturer, Visualization Workshop, IP-PAD Doctoral Network** 2025
Workshop on common plots in the social sciences, introduction to ggplot2, visualization best practices, and interactive coding challenge.

- Guest Lecturer, Good Research Practices, University of Amsterdam** 2025
Guest lectures on p-curve analysis, multiverse analysis, and causal inference in statistical control.
- Research Internship Supervisor, University of Amsterdam** 2025
Supervision of ten student theses, including literature review, data collection, data analysis, and report writing.
- Graduate TA, Introduction to Social Psychology, Cornell University** 2021–2022
Office hours for student support, creation of multiple-choice exam questions, exam instruction and administration, grading of essays.

Research Experience (Prior to the PhD)

- Graduate RA, Max-Planck-Institute for Research on Collective Goods (Prof. Susanne Fiedler)** 2022–2023
Literature reviews, teaching preparation, design of surveys/experiments, data analysis, coding of studies for a meta-analysis.
- Graduate Researcher, Cornell University (Prof. Thomas Gilovich)** 2021–2022
Independent project on polarizing political content on social media, literature review, survey and material design, data collection and analysis, lab presentations, manuscript preparation.
- Graduate Researcher, Cornell University (Prof. David Pizarro)** 2021–2022
Independent project on deliberate ignorance, literature review, survey and material design, data collection and analysis, lab presentations, manuscript preparation.
- Graduate RA, University of Heidelberg (Prof. Klaus Fiedler)** 2021–2022
Independent project on pseudo-contingencies, literature review on experience sampling and racial profiling, study and survey design (SoSciSurvey), data collection and analysis.

Academic and Community Service

- Reviewer:** *The Journal of Politics, Political Psychology, Social Cognition, European Journal of Political Research, Journal of European Public Policy, Journal of Experimental Political Science.*
- Organization of the IP-PAD Doctoral Network Conference** 2025
Organization of a conference with 60 attendees, including 2 keynote talks, roundtable discussions with academics and practitioners, and 22 research posters.
- HotPoliticsLab:** Chairing of Weekly Speaker Series 2023-2026
- PsyArXiv:** Emergency Moderation of Pre-Prints 2025
- Malengo:** Mentoring of a student from Uganda concerning living and studying in Germany 2022-2025
- PrEVENTion Heidelberg:** Foundation of a non-profit organization for the prevention of depression 2019-2023

Professional Experience

- Internship - Data and Polling at Public First** 2025
Data analysis (including quantitative text analysis), literature reviews, survey design, reporting and presentation for industry clients, quality control, client work support.
- Junior Consultant at CF Consulting** 2021
Joint moderation of digital assessment centers, preparation and implementation of online assessments, design of interviewer trainings (German/English).
- Internship at PE Systemtraining** 2020
Development of employee training materials, introduction of new IT tools and email system, contribution to website design.
- Internship at the Psychosis Ward of the State Hospital Andernach** 2020
Psychological interviews and psychoeducational group sessions.

Research and Transferable Skills

Research Design and Causal Inference:	Survey experiments and experimental design, multi-arm intervention designs and large-scale data collections, causal inference and statistical control, heterogeneous treatment effects (RATES).
Data Analysis, Statistics and Measurement:	Frequentist and Bayesian inference; analysis of large-N and multi-wave survey data; machine-learning methods for causal estimation (random forests for IPW); scale development and validation; automated classification of open responses (LLM-based).
Programming and Tools:	R/RStudio and Quarto (advanced), Shiny, LaTeX/Overleaf, Python(basics), Git(basics), Qualtrics.
Open Science:	Preregistration, reproducible analysis pipelines, replication.
Languages:	German (native), English (fluent), Dutch (basic knowledge)

References

Dr. Bert N. Bakker (Amsterdam School of Communication Research, University of Amsterdam)

Role: Daily Supervisor Ph.D.

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Prof. Gijs Schumacher (Department of Political Science, University of Amsterdam)

Role: Daily Supervisor Ph.D.

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